

Kitchen card · one pan

SoulJere's Cheesy Chicken & Rice Skillet

Seared chicken in creamy instant rice with broccoli and melted Colby Jack. One 12-inch skillet.*Chicken, broccoli rice, Colby Jack.*

Yield: about 4 servings · Active: 15 minutes · Chicken: 1.19 lb (half of a 2.38 lb thin-sliced pack) · Internal temp: 165°F

In the pan

Item	Amount	Notes
Thin-sliced boneless skinless chicken breasts	1.19 lb	Half of a 2.38 lb pack. Other half stays raw.
Refined sunflower oil	1 Tbsp	House sear oil. Neutral, high heat.
Greek-style all-purpose seasoning	1 to 1¼ tsp	On the chicken only. Cavender's if you have it. Or spice-rack mix — see options.
Condensed cream of chicken soup	1 can (10.5 oz)	Regular, not diluted before it hits the pan.
Water	1½ cups	Add 2–3 Tbsp extra if using frozen broccoli and the pan looks dry.
Instant 5-minute white rice, uncooked	2 cups	Instant only. Drop to 1½ cups for creamier rice.
Broccoli florets, fresh or frozen	2 cups (about 6 oz)	Bite-size. Goes in with the rice, not the sear.
Shredded Colby Jack	½–1 cup	Bagged shreds need an extra minute under the lid.

Method

- 1. Dry and season.** Pat the chicken dry on both sides. Dust with 1 to 1¼ tsp Greek-style blend, or the spice-rack mix. No extra salt. The soup is already salty.
- 2. Sear.** Heat a 12-inch skillet over medium-high. Add 1 Tbsp sunflower oil. When it shimmers, lay in the chicken. 2–3 minutes per side until you get color in spots. Do not cook through. Pull to a plate. Keep the brown bits in the pan.
- 3. Sauce.** Same pan: 1 can soup + 1½ cups water. Scrape the fond. Bring to a boil.
- 4. Rice and broccoli.** Stir in 2 cups uncooked instant rice and 2 cups bite-size broccoli florets. If using frozen broccoli and the pan looks tight, splash in 2–3 Tbsp more water.
- 5. Finish the chicken.** Nestle the chicken back in with any juices. Cover. Heat to low. 5 minutes.
- 6. Cheese.** Off heat. Sprinkle ½–1 cup Colby Jack over the top. Lid on 2 minutes (3 if the shreds are still stiff). Check the thickest piece: 165°F. Rest 2 minutes. Serve from the skillet.

Hard rules (do not skip)

- **Instant rice only in this method.** The 50-minute baked casserole uses uncooked long-grain rice. Instant rice in that bake turns to glue.
- **Do not salt the chicken on top of the blend.** These mixes start with salt. Taste at the end if you must.
- **Do not put 2.38 lb of chicken in one pan.** Half now. Other half stays raw — fridge 1–2 days or freeze. Season when you cook it.
- **Do not cook the chicken through in the sear.** Thin slices finish in the covered rice step. Over-sear now and they dry out.
- **Do not add broccoli to the hot oil.** It goes in with the rice. Long boil in the soup turns it army-green.
- **Do not rinse the chicken.** You just dried it so it would brown.

Options and substitutions

If you have / want	Use this	Do not
Cheese	Colby Jack (locked). Sharp cheddar works. ½–1 cup.	Don't skip the lid-melt. Bagged shreds have starch and take longer.
Oil	Refined sunflower (locked) or plain vegetable oil. 1 Tbsp.	Don't use toasted sesame or robust EVOO for the sear. Shortening only in a pinch.
Seasoning	1 to 1¼ tsp Greek-style blend (Cavender's if you have it). Spice rack: ¼ tsp garlic powder + ¼ tsp onion powder + ¼ tsp dried oregano + black pepper. Optional pinch of paprika in the sauce for color.	Don't stack extra salt on either mix. The soup is already salty.
Rice	2 cups instant white. 1½ cups if you want it creamier. Tight before cheese? Splash water. Loose? Rest uncovered 2 min.	Don't swap in uncooked long-grain or brown without changing time and liquid. Don't crank heat after rice goes in.
Broccoli	Fresh or frozen florets, bite-size, 2 cups. Frozen does not need thawing.	Don't use giant stems. Don't add at the sear.
No broccoli	Skip it. Original Sept 17 skillet had none. Same times.	Don't add extra rice to fill the gap.
Other vegetables	Frozen mixed veg can stand in for broccoli, same 2 cups, same step.	Don't add watery veg (fresh tomatoes) into the 5-minute steam.

If you have / want	Use this	Do not
Soup	1 can cream of chicken. 2 cans + ~2 cups water if you want it extra wet/creamy.	Don't dilute the can before it hits the pan unless you are changing the whole liquid math.
Whole pack of chicken (2.38 lb)	Two batches, or a second pan. One can of soup will not cover it.	Don't crowd 2.38 lb into one 12-inch skillet.
Heidi-style oven bake	Only if you switch to uncooked long-grain rice: soup + 1■ cups water + ¾ cup rice + veg, chicken on top, 375°F covered 50 min, cheese, stand 10 min.	Don't use the instant rice box in that bake.

Why it tastes like mo'

Fond in the pan dissolves into the soup. The seasoning brings salt, garlic, and oregano. The can is already gravy. Cheese adds fat. Scrape the brown bits. Do not wash the skillet between sear and sauce.

SoulJere's Kitchen · 165°F on the chicken.